

02 AUTOMATION AND ROBOTICS

Whether you like it or not, whether you think of it as the coolest thing ever, or you're fearing Judgement Day (as in the Terminator movies), automation is upon us.

Every other day we hear about a new type of robot being developed in labs, and then there are products available to actually buy. Robot vacuum cleaners, for one, are now so commonplace that they're not these rare things that billionaires have in their homes. When travelling abroad, inevitably you come across one in someone's home. You can buy really cheap ones for as little as ₹1,000, and the original



TOSY's Topio 3.0 humanoid robot playing table tennis.

Roomba series costs between ₹15,000 and ₹50,000 (not billionaire territory).

Robot pets aren't even fun anymore. In fact, as 2017 passes us by, it's not the kids who will be playing with robots, but more so the adults... if you know what we mean. Yes, commercial sexbots are going to become widely available to a lot of people starting 2017, and experts believe that by 2050 we will see people marrying robots! While that may be too far away to be an accurate prediction... it's typically the sex industry that brings in cutting edge technology. It's not just human-looking bots that will be hot in 2017, but also apps and accessories for smartphones. We expect a lot of first-world countries to start using apps that help you—err... fornicate with real people in a virtual setting. Both bots and apps like these are, in essence, the safest form of sex there will be.

Bots won't just be appealing to your sexuality in 2017 though...

there is a robot chef set to go on sale in 2017, and it might mean the end of cooking for all of us. Well... all of us with loads of space and a minimum of \$15,000 (just over ₹10 lakh). The price depends on how popular the demand is, and eventual retail price could be as high as \$75,000 (₹50 lakh). People buy cars that are way more expensive, and you would think that those people would also want a chef cooked meal everyday... yes, the kitchen watches chefs wearing motion capture equipment when they cook, and replicate the dish they prepare (and they copy better than any human ever could). You can buy a recipe from something akin to an app store, and tell the robot chef to cook your dinner while you're on your way home, so that you get a nice hot meal as soon as you arrive. This is way better than any sexbot in our opinion!

UNREAL LINKS

<http://dgit.in/AEternity>

<http://dgit.in/ARcrime>

<http://dgit.in/IntelMVR>

03 WHAT'S REAL?

With the big push VR saw in 2016, which directly followed the 3D push from a couple of years before that, the trend seems to be pretty straightforward to spot. We want a lot of fake stuff to appear to be very, very real.

Whether it's gamers who want to be immersed into real-looking environments, or movie watchers who want to be a part of the action, or even simpler YouTube style videos where we just want to be able to do our own thing... VR is certainly here to stay. Now, we're well aware that VR and AR aren't new technologies, in fact we've been using AR (using Blippar) on our covers for over two years now.

What will be new in 2017, and what you will see happening (or perhaps not see happening), is the integration of it into more than just the entertainment field.

We've already mentioned the—umm—private entertainment aspect of tech in the previous segment. That applies doubly here to VR and AR as well, but we're not going there...

Instead, there are concepts of AR being used in detective work

and crime scene investigations. For example, the Netherlands Forensic Institute are experimenting with AR to help an on scene officer get help from a crime scene expert who could be anywhere else on Earth. The officer's body cam sends video to the expert, they mark items of importance, which sends an update to the officer's smartphone (or VR headset if they so please), and you have the best crime scene investigators on call for challenging cases, without the need to arrange travel for them. The AR system will be made available to some police departments in 2017.

However, why stop at AR and VR if you can simulate yourself? A new concept called "Augmented eternity" aims to use AI to make a virtual you! Being developed jointly by MIT Media Labs and Ryerson University (Toronto), this concept aims to use the same machine learning that any big shopping website uses in their recommendation engines to analyse your purchases and suggest items to try and get you to spend more money... Except, this is that engine on some serious steroids! The goal is to



Razer's OSVR Hacker Dev Kit.

completely analyse everything you do, learn from you until the day you die, and then take over and continue to be you (virtually and digitally, of course). The idea is that if you want to know in the year 2100, "What would Obama have done?", you can just ask Virtual Obama, and get a pretty good estimate. In fact, since the virtual you continues to get new information and make decisions or have opinions, it won't even be "you", it will be some form of you that never died and kept living and updating itself!

NANO, NANO!

<http://dgit.in/MoleyMR>

<http://dgit.in/IsrRobot>

<http://dgit.in/Knights>

<http://dgit.in/AIAEpdf>